

Module 1: Introduction to Farmed Animal Advocacy

Scale of Animal Farming and Neglect towards them

Week 1 | Online-Synchronous | Tuesday

For this session, you will engage with materials that help answer two foundational questions in farmed animal advocacy: **How large is animal farming?** and **Why are farmed animals so widely neglected?** Together, these resources provide both global perspective and Philippine context.

Resources

A. Understanding the Scale of Animal Farming

These resources will help you grasp the magnitude of animal agriculture and why farmed animals constitute the largest group of animals directly affected by human activity.

1. [Food and Agriculture Organization of the United Nations – FAOSTAT: Livestock Primary Data \(Overview\)](#) (5 minute read)

This resource provides authoritative global data on livestock populations and production. As you read, focus on the number of animals involved and the types of production systems they are raised in, and consider what scale alone might imply for ethical and policy attention.

2. [Our World in Data – Meat and Dairy Production; Number of Animals Slaughtered](#) (20 minute read)

This resource visualizes global trends in animal slaughter and production across species. Pay attention to how scale varies between animals and regions, and how these trends have changed over time.

3. [Joon Sy -Animal Production in the Philippines: Trends, Challenges, and Contributions](#) (5 minute read)

This resource grounds the discussion in the Philippine context. As you review the data, consider how global patterns of animal farming are reflected locally, and which species dominate national production.

Additional resources can be researched online. You can explore the websites of both the Department of Agriculture or Bureau of Animal Industry.

B. Neglect of Farmed Animals

These resources explain why farmed animals are systematically overlooked, morally, politically, and institutionally.

1. [Sentience Institute – Why Farmed Animals Are Neglected \(Moral Circle Expansion\)](#)

This resource introduces the concept of neglectedness and explains why farmed animals are often excluded from moral concern and advocacy. As you read, reflect on which social, economic, or cultural factors contribute most to this neglect.

2. [Compassion in World Farming – Factory Farming Explained](#)

This global overview describes common practices in industrial animal agriculture and their welfare implications. Consider how these practices become normalized and why they often remain invisible to consumers and policymakers.

3. [Animal Welfare Act \(RA 8485, as amended by RA 10631\): Application to Farmed Animals](#)

This Philippine-focused reference allows you to examine how animal welfare protections are framed and limited in law and implementation. As you review it, consider where gaps exist between formal protections and on-the-ground realities for farmed animals.

Exercise: Seeing Scale and Neglect Clearly[1]

This exercise is designed to help you connect the data and concepts from the readings to your own assumptions and to the Philippine context. Please complete this exercise **before the live session**. You may write in bullet points or short paragraphs.

Making Scale Concrete: Using the FAO / Our World in Data / Philippine Statistics Authority resources, answer the following: 1. Which farmed animal species are produced or raised in the largest numbers globally? 2. Which species dominate animal farming in the Philippines?	Reflecting on Assumptions 6. Before engaging with these materials, how did you think about animal farming or farmed animals? 7. Did any of the readings challenge, complicate, or unsettle those views? If so, how?
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3. What surprised you most about the scale of animal farming—globally or locally—and why?	
Understanding Neglect: Drawing from the Sentience Institute and Compassion in World Farming materials: 4. In your own words, what does it mean to say that farmed animals are a “neglected” group? 5. Identify two structural reasons (e.g., economic, cultural, legal, political) that help explain why farmed animals receive limited moral or policy attention.	Looking Ahead 8. Based on what you’ve learned, what is one question about farmed animal advocacy that you now think is important but had not considered before?

Tools

SNS Framework. A tool for estimating the value of allocating marginal resources to solving a problem based on its scale, neglectedness, and solvability. We encourage you to try assessing your personal advocacy and/or a social issue in the Philippines using this framework. You can also view this [12-minute video](#) from Will MacAskill where he evaluated several causes as a reference.

Scale - How many and how badly are they affected?

Neglectedness - How much talent and funding is focused on this?

Solvability - Will adding more people and funding lead to progress?

Marginal and Counterfactual Impact. A tool for estimating the direct and indirect impact of a decision. This time, try to measure the marginal and counterfactual impact of choosing your current career or education and/or of pivoting to a new one. You can also skim through these articles from Probably Good to better grasp the concept of [marginal](#) and [counterfactual impact](#).

Marginal Impact - What is the additional impact that this decision has created?

Counterfactual Impact - What would have happened in the absence of this decision.